



Security Certifications and Penetration Test Planning

CEN429 Secure Programming — Week 12

Asst. Prof. Dr. Uğur CORUH · 04.12.2026

Today's Plan (3 Hours)

Hour	Section	Topic
1	1–2	Why independent evaluation · the standards landscape · the evaluation process (13 steps)
2	3–5	Vulnerability-assessment methods · the tests the standards demand · attack potential and rating
3	6–9	Finding→recommendation→action and impact analysis · penetration test plan · reporting · project (S16)

Learning outcome (LO.6 / LO.7): explain the steps of independent evaluation · write a **penetration test plan** · **rate** a finding (attack potential, CVSS)

Where Does This Week Fit?

- **Weeks 4–11:** we learned the protections (memory, crypto, obfuscation, whitebox...)
- **This week (12):** but do these protections **really work**? How are they **tested**?
- **Week 13:** security requirements and the compliance matrix

Today: independent evaluation + penetration test planning.



Ethical and Legal Framework (From the Start)

A penetration test **cannot be done** without **written permission** and a contract with an explicitly defined scope.

- Unauthorized testing is a **crime**, whatever the intent.
- In this course, testing is done only on **your own** project.
- All data is **synthetic**; there is no real personal data.

What We Bring from Earlier Weeks

- **Vulnerability** — a weak point that can be abused, e.g., an unbounded buffer (**Week 1**)
- **Kerckhoffs's principle** — security must rest on the secrecy of the key, not on the secrecy of the design (**Week 3**)
- **Static and dynamic analysis** — finding bugs without running the code (static) or while running it with sanitizers (dynamic) (**Week 4**)
- **Fuzzing** — looking for crashes with unexpected/random input (**Week 4**)
- **CVSS** — a scoring system expressing a vulnerability's impact as a standard score (0–10) (**Week 2**)

This week: we rebuild these concepts in the language of an independent **evaluation**.

This Week's Concepts

Each term is defined once, where it first appears in the body; here we only mark **where**.

Concept	Where
Security evaluation, certification, standard, laboratory	Section 1
TOE, white/black box, the 13-step evaluation process	Section 2
Vulnerability, assessment methods (code review, SAST, DAST, fuzzing)	Section 3
The tests the standards demand	Section 4
Attack potential, CVSS	Section 5
Finding, recommendation, action, security impact analysis, delta assessment	Section 6
Penetration test, penetration test plan, test card	Section 7

Now: **why independent evaluation?**



1. Why Independent Evaluation?

What Is a Security Evaluation?

- **Security evaluation:** an **independent** party **testing** a product's security claims.
- Saying "I am secure" is not enough; **evidence** and **testing** are required.

What Is Certification?

- **Certification:** an authorized party **documenting** that a product/organisation complies with a given **standard**.
- If the evaluation succeeds, a **certificate** is issued.

Who Is the Laboratory (Evaluator)?

- **Evaluation laboratory:** the independent, accredited organisation that tests the product.
- It is **not** the organisation that develops the product (for impartiality).
- It has access to all source code and documentation.

What Is a Standard?

- **Standard:** a common set of rules defining what should be done and how.
- Examples: ISO/IEC 27001, Common Criteria, FIPS 140-3, PCI, OWASP MASVS.
- Each measures something different (more on this shortly).

Independent Evaluation — Diagram

Neden bağımsız değerlendirme?

üretici kendi ürününü onaylayamaz

Geliştiricinin sözü
tarafıdır (çıkar çatışması)
kendi hatasına kördür
elinde kanıt yoktur

“bence güvenli”

Bağımsız değerlendirme
tarafsız laboratuvar
tanımlı yöntem
KANIT üretir

“şu testte şu sonuç”

Değerlendirici iki şey varsayar: saldırgan sistemi tam bilir ve yetenekli/kaynaklıdır.

"My Code Is Secure" Is Not Enough

- A developer can be **blind** to their own code.
- Conflict of interest: you want to say "my product is secure."
- That's why **third-party** verification is required.

What Does Trust Rest On?

- Not on claims, but on **evidence** and **testing**.
- An independent laboratory: impartial, accredited, expert.
- Result: a **certificate** or a **finding list**.

A Short History — Evaluation and Certification

- 1985 — **TCSEC** ("Orange Book"): the first formal evaluation criteria
- 1991–93 — European **ITSEC**, Canadian **CTCPEC**
- 1999 — **Common Criteria (ISO/IEC 15408)**; the **EAL** scale comes from here
- 2001 **OWASP** · **PTES/NIST SP 800-115** · 2005→2023 **CVSS** (v2→v4.0)
- 2010s — **MASVS/MASTG** (mobile), **ETSI EN 303 645** (IoT)

One sentence: **a vendor cannot approve its own product** — independent, **evidence-based** evaluation.

The Evaluator's Two Assumptions

1. **White-box:** it has access to all source code and documents.
2. **Platform is untrusted:** the environment the product runs on is exposed to the attacker.

White-Box vs. Black-Box Testing

- **White-box testing:** the tester has access to **source code + documentation**.
- **Black-box testing:** the tester accesses the system only from the outside (like a user).
- The evaluator usually works **white-box** (sees everything).

The Consequence of These Assumptions

A protection merely **existing** is not enough.

The evaluator asks: **how easily is it bypassed?**

- Not a single protection,
- but the time it takes to bypass protections **together**.

In Good Design the Attacker Is Forced

- A single protection → bypassed in a single step.
- Layered protection → the attacker must **chain** the layers.

This is the evaluation counterpart of the "layered defence" idea from weeks 9 and 11.



The Standards Landscape

Standards Map — Diagram

Standartlar manzarası: hangisi neyi sertifikalar?

“sertifikalı” demek, NEYİN sertifikalandığını bilmeden anlamsızdır

ISO/IEC 27001

KURUMU — bilgi güvenliği yönetim sistemi

Ortak Kriterler (15408)

ÜRÜNÜ — TOE, belirli güvence düzeyinde

FIPS 140-3

KRİPTOGRAFİK MODÜLÜ

ETSI EN 303 645

tüketici IoT cihazı

OWASP MASVS / ASVS

uygulama — geliştirici dostu öz-değerlendirme

Kurum sertifikası ürün güvenliğini, ürün sertifikası kurum olgunluğunu göstermez.

Why Are There So Many Standards?

Each standard secures a **different** thing:

- the organisation, the product, or the crypto module?
- which domain (IoT, payments, mobile)?

Knowing which one your project is closest to tells you which tests to prioritise.

ISO/IEC 27001

- **What:** certifies the **organisation** (its processes).
- Not the product, but the organisation's information security management.
- Asks for **control evidence** instead of testing.

Common Criteria (ISO/IEC 15408)

- **What:** certifies the **product**.
- Source review + vulnerability analysis + penetration test + **attack potential**.
- Depth increases with **EAL** (week 13).

FIPS 140-3

- **What:** the **cryptographic module**.
- Algorithm validation, self-tests.
- Covers only the **module**, not the whole application (week 13).

ETSI EN 303 645

- **What:** baseline **IoT** security requirements.
- A light, broad-coverage baseline.
- E.g., "store sensitive parameters securely".

EMVCo / PCI

- **What: payment** products.
- Functional conformance + laboratory penetration test + attack potential.
- Strict and detailed.

OWASP MASVS + MASTG

- **MASVS**: mobile application security **requirements**.
- **MASTG**: the **test guide** for testing them.
- The **most applicable** guide for your project.

Standards · One Table

Standard	What It Certifies
ISO/IEC 27001	Organisation (process)
Common Criteria	Product (EAL)
FIPS 140-3	Crypto module
ETSI EN 303 645	IoT baseline
EMVCo / PCI	Payments
OWASP MASVS/MASTG	Mobile application

Organisation or Product? (Often Confused)

- **ISO/IEC 27001:** organisation.
- **Common Criteria:** product.

An organisation can hold ISO 27001 while its product has not been evaluated; the reverse is also true.

Section 1 — Quick Check

1. Why isn't it enough for the developer to say "it's secure"?
2. The evaluator's two assumptions?
3. What do ISO 27001 and Common Criteria certify separately?

Section 1 — Answers

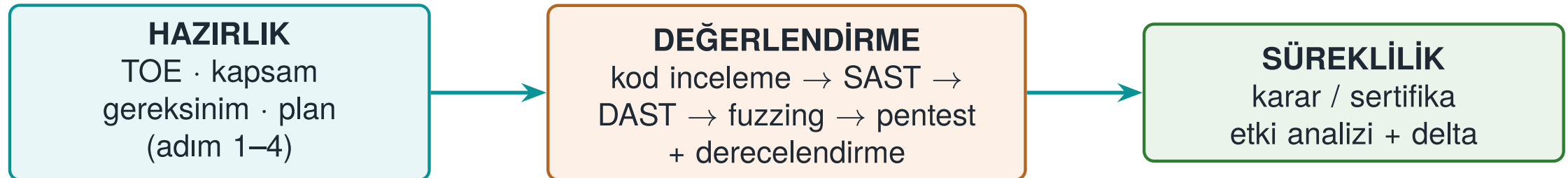
1. The developer is a **party with interest** (conflict of interest), is **blind** to its own mistakes, and has no **evidence** in hand. An independent evaluator verifies with evidence.
2. (1) The attacker **fully knows** the system (Kerckhoffs), (2) the attacker is **skilled and resourced**. Assume the worst case.
3. **ISO 27001 certifies the organisation/process** (information security management), **Common Criteria certifies the product** (TOE) at a given assurance level.

2. The Evaluation Process: 13 Steps

The Evaluation Process — Diagram

Değerlendirme süreci: üç aşama, 13 adım

üretici kendi ürününü onaylayamaz



Sertifika bir anlık fotoğraftır: her değişiklikte etki analizi ve delta değerlendirme gerekir.

Three Phases

The process is split into three phases:

- **Preparation** (1–4)
- **Evaluation** (5–8)
- **Result and continuity** (9–13)

Now let's take them one by one.

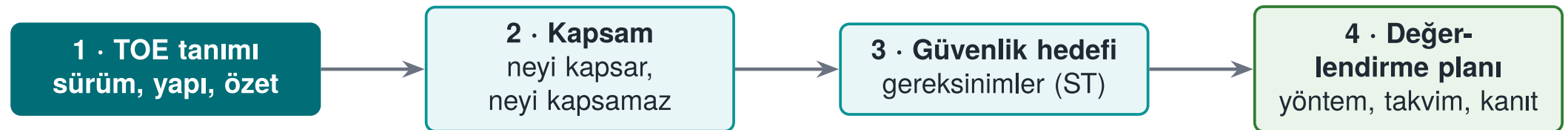


Preparation (Steps 1–4)

Preparation Steps — Diagram

Hazırlık aşaması: adım 1–4

yanlış tanımlanmış TOE, tüm değerlendirmeyi geçersiz kılar



TOE benzersiz tanımlanmazsa “hangi sürüm sertifikalı?” sorusu yanıtız kalır.

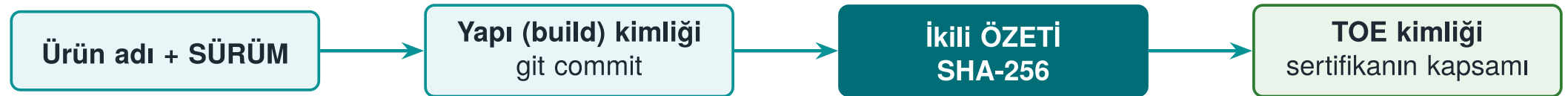
Step 1 · Target of Evaluation (TOE)

- What is to be evaluated is defined **uniquely**.
- A version number **is not enough**: binary + source + hash value/label.
- Out-of-scope components are written down.
- **In your project**: S0, S1 (version identity, week 1).

TOE Identity — Diagram

TOE neden benzersiz tanımlanır?

sertifika bir ANLIK FOTOĞRAFTIR



Tanım belirsizse başka bir sürüm “sertifikalı” görünür — sertifika geçersizleşir.

Step 1 · Why Unique?

- The report is only valid for the **binary examined**.
- "v1.2" can point to two different builds.
- The hash value pins down exactly which file it is.

Step 2 · Delivery of Documents

- Source code, API documentation, **security guide**.
- Debug and release builds.
- Delivered over a secure channel.
- **In your project:** your repo + your guide.

Step 3 · Requirement Template

- The standard's **numbered** requirements.
- For each: the text, **test coverage**, the developer's **compliance rationale + document reference**.
- Status: met / transferred / not met.
- **In your project:** S17 compliance matrix (week 13).

Step 4 · Workshop

- Which control meets which requirement?
- How will gaps be closed?
- A document-update plan comes out of it.



Evaluation (Steps 5–8)

Step 5 · Source Code Review

- All source is reviewed in a **white-box** context.
- Dangerous patterns, incorrect crypto, leak points.
- **In your project:** week 4 CERT, static analysis.

Step 5 · Where Does the Evaluator Look?

- Is crypto usage correct? Where does the key come from/go to?
- Input validation, memory (bounds, overflow, UAF).
- Secret leakage in logs/errors.
- Control-bypass paths.

Step 6 · Vulnerability Analysis

- Assets and the **key hierarchy** are extracted.
- For every asset: "where, in what state, is it exposed?"
- Output: finding list + **penetration test plan**.
- **In your project:** S4, S5, S16.

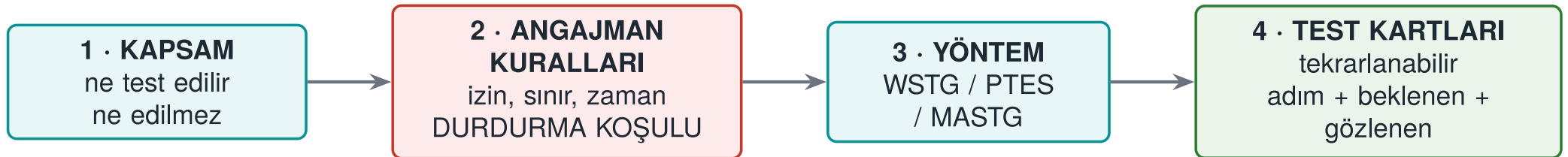
Step 7 · Penetration Test

- Every item in the plan is carried out with the **eight-field** template.
- Every finding is rated with **attack potential**.
- Output: test result tables.
- **In your project:** S16.

Penetration Test Plan — Diagram

Sızma testi planının dört başlığı

plan olmadan yapılan test ne tekrarlanabilir ne de savunulabilir



Durdurma koşulu, gerçek zarar/veri kaybı riskini sınırlar — etik ve güvenli yürütme.

Step 8 · Functional Conformance

- The product's standard functions (e.g., payment flows) are tested with the scheme's **test suite**.
- Output: execution report.
- **In your project:** unit tests.



Result and Continuity (Steps 9–13)

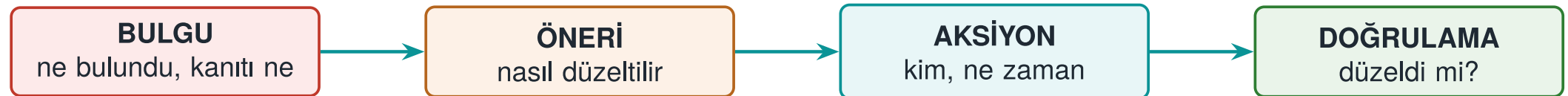
Step 9 · Findings and Fixes

- For every finding, the laboratory produces a **recommendation**, the developer produces an **action**.
- Some findings close as "not a security issue, a good-practice suggestion".
- **In your project:** week 7 finding–action list.

Finding Cycle — Diagram

Bulgu → öneri → aksiyon döngüsü

her bulgu bir sahip ve bir tarih alır



Bir bulgu, gerçekten sömürülemez olduğu KANITLANIRSA “etkilenmez” diye kapanır (VEX).

Step 10 · Security Impact Analysis

- When fixes produce a new version:
 - change category (new feature / improvement / bug fix)
 - affected files
 - security impact
- **In your project:** S13, change management.

Impact Analysis ↔ Delta — Diagram

Etki analizi ↔ delta değerlendirme

her değişiklikte tüm ürün baştan değerlendirilmez

ETKİ ANALİZİ
GELİŞTİRİCİNİN çıktısı

bu değişiklik güvenliği
ya da TOE'yi etkiler mi?

DELTA DEĞERLENDİRME
LABORATUVARIN işi

etkilenen kısmı bağımsız
yeniden değerlendirir

Sertifikanın sürdürülmesi bu iki adıma bağlıdır.

Step 11 · Delta Assessment

- Only the **changed part** is re-evaluated.
- The laboratory asks for: marked-up documents, impact analysis, file list, the **new TOE identity**.

Step 12 · Trade-Off and Residual Risk

- The cost of every protection is measured.
- Decisions are justified.
- **Residual risk is written explicitly.**
- **In your project:** week 1 trade-off record.

Step 13 · Change Management

Baseline → request → classification → approval → development and testing → release → verification.

- **In your project:** S13.

13 Steps · At a Glance

Preparation: 1 TOE · 2 documents · 3 requirement template · 4 workshop

Evaluation: 5 code review · 6 vulnerability · 7 penetration · 8 functional

Result: 9 finding · 10 impact · 11 delta · 12 residual risk · 13 change

End-to-End Example · NotKasa v1.0.0

A synthetic mobile application: "NotKasa" (keeps encrypted notes locally).

- Encrypts notes with AES.
- Downloads the key from the server.
- Logging is off in the release build.

We'll evaluate this product start to finish.

Applying Step 1 · TOE

- **TOE:** NotKasa v1.0.0, `notkasa-1.0.0.apk`
- Hash (SHA-256): `a1b2...` (synthetic)
- Source: `notkasa/` repository, tag `v1.0.0`
- Out of scope: server infrastructure

Steps 2–3 · Documents and Requirement Template

- Delivered: source, security guide, both debug and release APKs.
- Requirement template: MASVS items numbered; each with status + evidence reference.

Step 5 · Code Review Findings (Synthetic)

- **B-01:** the key is erased in an intermediate variable, but the `tmp` buffer is **not erased** (it stays in memory).
- **B-02:** the error message on a decode failure leaks internal detail.

Step 6 · Vulnerability Analysis

- Assets: note content (C/I), data key (C/I), server token.
- Question: **where** is each asset exposed?
- Output: a penetration test plan (below).

Step 7 · Penetration Test Card (Summary)

- **T-01** plaintext on disk? → pass (encrypted)
- **T-02** does the key stay in memory? → **fail** (B-01 confirmed)
- **T-03** does the error message leak? → **fail** (B-02)

Step 7 · T-02 Rating

- Time: low · expertise: moderate · knowledge: public · equipment: free (memory dump)
- → **moderate-low attack potential**
- CVSS: medium (confidentiality impact)

Step 9 · Finding–Action

Finding	Recommendation	Action
B-01 key residue	Erase <code>tmp</code> after use	Added (memset-like)
B-02 error leak	Return a single generic error	Fixed

Steps 10–11 · Impact Analysis + Delta

- The fixes produced v1.0.1.
- **Impact analysis:** 2 files changed, both on the memory/error path; the crypto flow did not change.
- **Delta:** only these two files + the new TOE identity (`notkasa-1.0.1.apk`) were re-evaluated.

Step 12 · Residual Risk

- If the device is rooted, a memory dump is still possible.
- Mitigation: short-lived key + server-side risk check.
- **Written explicitly.**

Case · Takeaway

- The 13 steps aren't abstract; they're **concrete** in a small product.
- Evaluation is a **cycle**: find → fix → re-evaluate.
- Your project is a scaled-down version of this.

Where Does the Guide Fit?

- The security guide that is the source of this course's "How it's done in the field" notes = the **document delivered at step 2**.
- Its primary reader: the **laboratory**.
- Every section opens with a requirement block ("requirement — status").
- **The guide in your project is a scaled-down version of this.**

Section 2 — Quick Check

1. The three phases, and roughly which steps?
2. Why is the TOE defined uniquely?
3. The relationship between impact analysis and delta assessment?

Section 2 — Answers

1. **Preparation** (TOE, scope, requirements, plan · 1–4), **Evaluation** (apply method, test, rate), **Result** (report, compliance, decision, ongoing delta maintenance).
2. To **pin down precisely** what is certified: version, build, hash, configuration. Otherwise a different version can appear "certified."
3. On a change, first the **impact analysis** (does it affect security?); if it does, not the whole product but only the **delta** (the changed part) is re-evaluated.

3. Vulnerability-Assessment Methods

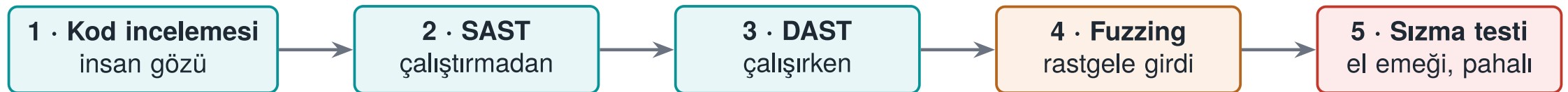
What Is a Vulnerability?

- **Vulnerability:** a **weak point** in a system that can be abused (e.g., an unbounded buffer).
- Vulnerability + abuse = a security incident.

Evaluation Methods — Diagram

Zafiyet değerlendirme yöntemleri: ucuzdan pahalıya

erken adımlar kolay bulguları eler; pahalı adım yalnız kalanlara harcanır



Geliştirici önce kendi test ederse değerlendirmeye “temiz” gider — maliyet düşer.

Purpose

Steps 5–6 of the process require using a set of methods **in the right order**.

Question: "How do I test my own product before I deliver it?"

The Right Order: Cheap to Expensive

1. Source code review (manual)
2. Static analysis (SAST)
3. Dynamic analysis (DAST) + sanitizer
4. Fuzzing
5. Penetration test

Cheap + broad → expensive + deep.

Why This Order?

- **SAST** is cheap, scans broadly; but produces false positives.
- **Manual review** is expensive; but sees context.
- **Fuzzing** requires running the program; finds what no one would think of.
- **Penetration test** is the most expensive; comes last.

Clear "easy" findings first with cheap methods → the penetration test can focus on real, combined problems.

Method 1 · Source Code Review

- Finds **logic** errors that automated tools miss.
- A human eye sees context and intent.

Code Review · Where to Look (1)

- **Crypto:** is the right algorithm/mode/padding used? Where does the key come from/go to/get erased? (weeks 3, 10, 11)

Code Review · Where to Look (2)

- **Input/memory:** bounds checking, integer overflow, format string, UAF (week 4 CERT).
- **Leakage:** sensitive data in logs, internal state in errors.
- **Bypass:** a control that can be bypassed with a single branch/return (week 9).

Method 2 · Static Analysis (SAST)

- Scans the source **without running it**.
- Memory errors, dangerous calls, patterns.
- Fast; but **false positives** must be handled.

Method 3 · Dynamic Analysis (DAST)

- Tests the program **while running it**.
- Sanitizers (ASan/UBSan) catch memory-access errors, undefined behaviour.

Method 4 · Fuzzing

- The program is fed **unexpected inputs**.
- Crash/corruption paths are found.
- Reveals cases a human would never think of.

Method 5 · Penetration Test

- **Combines** the methods above, tests exploitability from an attacker's viewpoint.
- The most expensive; comes last.
- We'll plan it in detail in section 5.

Critical Point: The Developer Goes First

- These tools must also be run **by the developer**, and the results (S16) presented.
- The big difference for the evaluator:
 - "no one has tested this" vs.
 - "these tools were run, these findings were closed".

This is the counterpart of week 4's **secure build pipeline** (SAST + sanitizer + fuzz in CI).

Section 3 — Quick Check

1. Why do we order the methods cheap to expensive?
2. What is SAST's weakness?
3. Why does it matter that the developer tests first?

Section 3 — Answers

1. Cheap/automated methods (SAST/DAST) **filter out** easy findings early; expensive human effort is spent only on what remains → efficient.
2. **SAST** doesn't run the code → high **false positives**, cannot see runtime/configuration/business-logic flaws, doesn't know context.
3. It closes easy findings **cheaply** (goes clean to the evaluator), lowers cost/delay → evaluation can focus on deep problems.

4. The Tests the Standards Demand

Each Standard Emphasises Different Tests

Whichever family your project is closest to, do the tests it expects first.

Standards · Test Expectations

Standard	Primary Test
ISO/IEC 27001	Process/management audit
Common Criteria	Review + vulnerability + penetration + attack potential
FIPS 140-3	Crypto module testing
ETSI EN 303 645	Baseline requirement verification
EMVCo / PCI	Functional + penetration + attack potential
MASVS/MASTG	Mobile static + dynamic

Test Methodology Guides

Mature public guides exist for **how** to run a penetration test:

- **OWASP WSTG** (web)
- **OWASP MASTG** (mobile)
- **PTES, NIST SP 800-115** (general process)

These are not an "attack recipe," they are **methodology** — they make the result repeatable/comparable.



5. Attack Potential and Finding Rating

What Is Attack Potential?

- **Attack potential: how difficult** it is to carry out an attack.
- Scored with factors such as time, expertise, and equipment.
- Low potential (an easy attack) = a serious finding.

Not "Yes/No" but "How Hard?"

A protection merely existing is not enough; **how easily it is bypassed** is measured.

Common Criteria and payment schemes do this with **attack potential**.

This is the formal counterpart of week 9's "measuring obfuscation" (potency/resilience) framework.

The Question: "What Did It Take to Break?"

A finding's severity is decided by the answer to this question.

We score it with five–six factors; the points are summed; the total maps to a **resistance level**.

Factor 1 · Elapsed Time

- How long did the attack take?
- **Low score:** a day. **High score:** months.

Factor 2 · Expertise

- What level of skill was required?
- **Low:** an ordinary user. **High:** a domain expert.

Factor 3 · Knowledge of the Target

- What needed to be known about the product?
- **Low:** publicly available information. **High:** internal/confidential documents.

Factor 4 · Window of Opportunity

- How much access/how many attempts were needed?
- **Low:** unlimited/remote. **High:** restricted physical access.

Factor 5 · Equipment

- Which tools were needed?
- **Low:** standard, free. **High:** specialised, expensive.

Factors · One Table

Factor	Low	High
Elapsed time	A day	Months
Expertise	Ordinary	Expert
Knowledge of target	Public	Confidential document
Window of opportunity	Unlimited/remote	Restricted physical
Equipment	Free	Specialised/expensive

Interpretation: Low Total = Serious Finding

- **High** total → the attack is hard → the protection is good.
- **Low** total (ordinary user, one hour, free tool) → **serious finding**.

The logic is the same as week 9's four metrics.

Worked Example (Synthetic)

"A licence check in the release build depended on a branch that an ordinary-level user, with a free disassembler, found in an hour and bypassed with a single-byte patch."

Example · Scoring

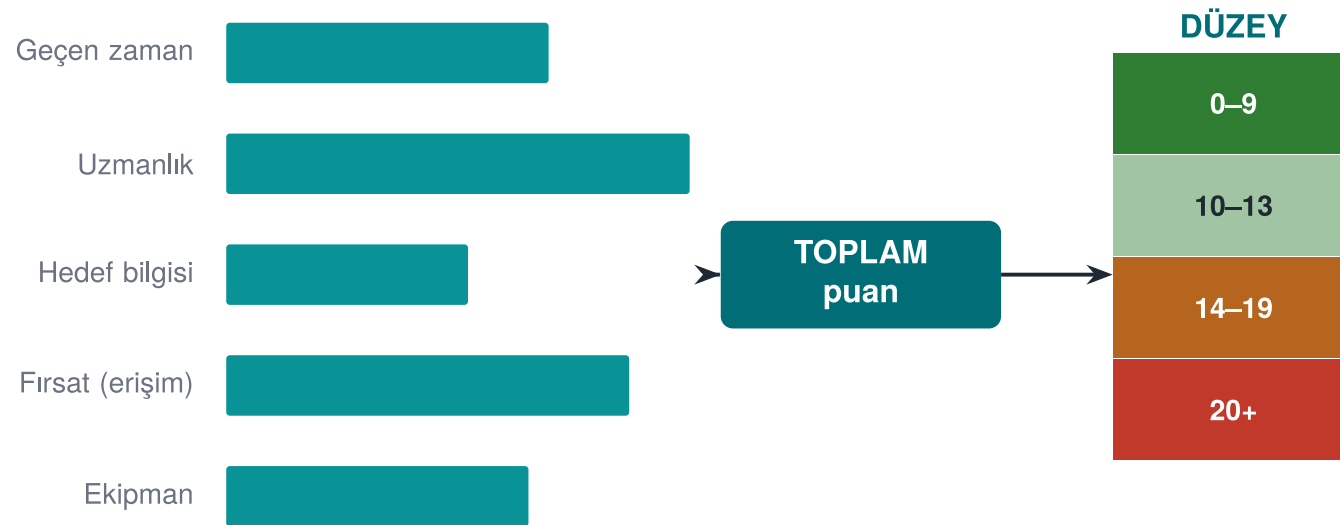
- Time: low · expertise: moderate · knowledge: public · equipment: free
- → **low attack potential** → **serious finding**

Recommendation: opaque boolean + random exit (week 9) + server-side check.

Attack Potential — Five Factors

Saldırı potansiyeli: beş faktör

toplam puan → direnç düzeyi



DÜŞÜK puan = az zaman/beceri/araç → çok saldırgan olabilir → **YÜKSEK RİSK**

Saldırı potansiyeli saldırının ZORLUĞUNU, CVSS ise açığın ETKİSİNİ ölçer.

What Is CVSS?

- **CVSS (Common Vulnerability Scoring System):** expresses a vulnerability's **impact** as a standard score (0–10).
- Higher score = more severe impact.
- Used for prioritisation.

Attack Potential ↔ CVSS — Diagram

Saldırı potansiyeli ↔ CVSS

farklı eksenler — biri diğerinin yerine geçmez

SALDIRI POTANSİYELİ

saldırı ne kadar ZOR?

zaman · uzmanlık · bilgi
fırsat · ekipman
→ olabilirlik

CVSS

açık ne kadar KÖTÜ?

gizlilik/bütünlük/erişilebilirlik
etkisi
→ ciddiye

Bulgu raporunda ikisi birlikte verilir; önceliklendirme ikisine göre yapılır.

What Does CVSS Add?

- Attack potential: "how **hard** is it to break?"
- CVSS: "how **big** is this vulnerability's impact?"

The two complement each other.

CVSS · Likelihood vs. Impact

- One weighs **likelihood** (the attack's difficulty), the other **impact** (loss of confidentiality/integrity/availability).
- Both are usually given **together** in the report.
- Prioritisation is based on both.

Section 5 — Quick Check

1. The five factors of attack potential?
2. Why is a low attack potential a serious finding?
3. What do attack potential and CVSS each measure?

Section 5 — Answers

1. **Elapsed time · expertise · knowledge of the target · opportunity (access) · equipment.**
2. It means the exploit can be done with **little** time/skill/tools → many more attackers can do it → a broad, likely threat → high risk.
3. **Attack potential** measures the attack's **difficulty/cost**; **CVSS** measures the vulnerability's **severity/impact**. Different axes, used together.

6. Finding → Recommendation → Action and Impact Analysis

What Is a Finding?

- **Finding:** a problem or improvement point identified during evaluation.
- Every finding needs: evidence, severity, a **recommendation**.

Evaluation Is a Cycle

Not a "pass/fail" stamp, but an **improvement cycle**.

Four steps for every finding:

Four Steps

1. **Finding:** what the laboratory found (with evidence, repeatable).
2. **Recommendation:** the suggested direction of the fix.
3. **Action:** what the developer did (or why not).
4. **Closure:** some findings close as "not open, a good-practice suggestion".

This cycle → the source of the post-midterm **finding–action list** (week 7).

Why Do We Need These?

Fixes produce a new version.

Re-evaluating everything from scratch is **expensive**.

Two documents come into play (steps 10–11).

Security Impact Analysis

- Classifies changes: new feature / improvement / bug fix.
- Lists affected files.
- Writes the **security impact** of each change.
- **The developer's** output.

Delta Assessment

- Based on this document, re-evaluates **only the changed part**.
- Asks for: marked-up documents, change list, file list, **new TOE identity**.
- **The laboratory's** job.

Do Not Confuse the Two

- **Impact analysis:** *documents* the change's impact (developer).
- **Delta assessment:** *re-evaluates* only the change (laboratory).

If the version identity/hash is inconsistent, delta **cannot be done** (the evaluated product becomes ambiguous).

Section 6 — Quick Check

1. Whose job is impact analysis, whose is delta?

Section 6 — Answers

1. **Impact analysis is the developer's** job (they initiate the assessment of the change's impact); **delta assessment is the evaluator's** job (they independently re-review it).



7. Penetration Test Plan

What Was a Penetration Test?

- An activity that **combines** the methods from an attacker's viewpoint, **planned** and **permitted**.
- "Planned" and "permitted" are not optional.

A plan contains at least four headings.

Heading 1 · Scope

- What will **and won't** be tested is written explicitly.
- Which binary/version, which components, which environment (test or production), which data (synthetic only).
- Out-of-scope items are also written down (third-party servers, real user data).

Heading 2 · Rules of Engagement (1)

- **Written permission** and an authorised signature.
- The test window (date/time).
- Permitted and **forbidden** methods (e.g., excluding those that cause service disruption).

Heading 2 · Rules of Engagement (2)

- Data rule: **no** real personal data; findings are confidential.
- **Kill switch:** if a critical impact is observed, the test stops, reported immediately.
- Communication and escalation points.

Heading 3 · Methodology

- Choose a recognised methodology and follow it:
 - mobile: **OWASP MASTG/MASVS**
 - web: **OWASP WSTG**
 - general: **PTES, NIST SP 800-115**
- Goal: the result is **repeatable** and **comparable**.

Heading 4 · Test Template

Every test is written with the same **eight-field** card.

This card is your project's **S16** skeleton. Let's look at the fields now.

Test Card · Fields 1–4

1. **Test ID:** a unique number
2. **Related requirement:** which asset/requirement it tests (S17 link)
3. **Purpose:** what is being verified
4. **Preconditions:** environment, version, data

Test Card · Fields 5–8

5. **Method/steps:** in repeatable form
6. **Expected result:** what secure behaviour should be
7. **Observed result:** what happened (with evidence)
8. **Decision:** attack potential + pass/fail + recommendation

Test Card · One Table

Field	Content
ID	Unique number
Requirement	Link to S17
Purpose	What is verified
Precondition	Environment, version, data
Steps	Repeatable
Expected	Secure behaviour
Observed	What happened (evidence)
Decision	Attack pot. + pass/fail + recommendation

Worked Example · Test Card (1)

ID: T-05

Requirement: the sensitive record in the local database must be protected with AEAD (S17)

Purpose: is the record found in plaintext on disk?

Worked Example · Test Card (2)

Precondition: release build, a synthetic record inserted

Steps: run the application → add a record → scan the database file with `strings`

Expected: plaintext is **not visible**

Worked Example · Test Card (3)

Observed: no plaintext visible (only an encrypted blob) — evidence: output screenshot

Decision: pass · attack potential high (an easy attack failed)

The goal isn't to find a flaw, it's to learn **to write a proper card**.

Team Activity (In Class)

- Each team picks **one asset** from its own project.
- Fills in **one** test card for it.
- 15 minutes; then a few cards are shared.

Card · Crypto Verification

- **Purpose:** are notes really encrypted with AEAD?
- **Step:** inspect the encrypted blob's header/tag; is a corrupted tag rejected?
- **Expected:** corrupted tag → decryption is rejected.

Card · Key Lifecycle

- **Purpose:** is the key erased once the job is done?
- **Step:** scan memory after the operation.
- **Expected:** key bytes are not found.

Card · Release/Debug Distinction

- **Purpose:** is logging really off in the release build?
- **Step:** search the release APK with `strings` for the log string.
- **Expected:** the log string is absent.

Card · Upgrade Safety

- **Purpose:** can an old signed version be restored?
- **Step:** try installing a lower version.
- **Expected:** the downgrade is rejected.

Rule When Writing Cards

- Every card must be **repeatable** (someone else must be able to follow the same steps).
- Every card is linked to a **requirement** (S17).
- The "Observed" field is filled with **evidence**.

Section 7 — Quick Check

1. The plan's four headings?
2. Why does the "kill switch" exist?
3. Which field of the test card links to S17?

Section 7 — Answers

1. **Scope · rules (RoE) · methodology · test cards** (+ kill switch, reporting).
2. To limit real **harm/data loss/disruption** risk; at a defined threshold the test **stops** → safe and ethical execution.
3. The test card's **result/requirement-met** field → links as evidence to the **S17 compliance matrix**.



8. Reporting

The Report's Four Sections — Diagram

Raporlama: aynı bulgu, üç farklı okuyucu

rapor bir liste değil, bir karar belgesidir

Yönetici özeti

kaç bulgu, en yüksek risk, karar gerektiren tek cümle

Teknik bulgu kayıtları

kanıt, yeniden üretim adımları, CVSS + saldırı potansiyeli

Düzeltilme önerileri

somut, önceliklendirilmiş, sahibi belli

Kalan risk

kabul edilen riskler ve gerekçesi — imzalanır

Kanıtı olmayan bulgu iddiadır; sahibi olmayan öneri hiç yapılmaz.

A Good Report = a Decidable Document

Not a list of "you failed."

The reader must be able to decide **what to do**.

Report Sections (1)

- **Executive summary:** overall status for the non-technical reader + the three most critical findings.
- **Methodology and scope:** what was tested, what wasn't, with which methodology.

Report Sections (2)

- **Findings:** each with evidence + attack potential + CVSS + recommendation.
- **Finding–action table:** the developer's response, closure.
- **Residual risk:** what wasn't closed/was transferred, with justification.

Critical-Reading Exercise

Read a short finding text together:

- Was the attack potential rated correctly?
- Is the recommendation actionable?
- Does the "met" row have **evidence**?

This is a rehearsal for reading the compliance matrix in week 13.



9. Term Project: This Week (S16)

Project · S16 (Test Plan + Results) — 1

1. Write **eight-field** test cards for the two–three most critical assets/requirements (linked to S17).

Project · S16 — 2

2. Methodology: state which methodology (MASTG / WSTG / PTES / NIST SP 800-115) you're basing it on.

Project · S16 — 3

3. **Results:** run the tests and write the **observed results**.

At the final, a plan is not expected, a **result** is.

Project · S16 — 4, 5

4. **Finding-action:** pour your midterm feedback into a table.

5. **Residual risk:** write the risks you didn't close and why.

Ethics (Again)

- Test only on **your own** project and systems you're authorised for.
- Unauthorised testing is a crime.
- All data is **synthetic**; no real secrets/personal data in the repo.

Common Mistakes · Summary

Mistake	Section
A plan but no result — assuming "we will test" is enough	9 (S16)
"Met" without evidence — no evidence reference in the compliance matrix	2 (S17)
Version inconsistency — the guide and the code are at different versions	2 (TOE)
Residual risk left empty	6
Midterm feedback ignored	6 / 9
Real secrets/personal data in the repo	Ethical framework

Each row is a **violation** of that section's discipline — go back and re-read the source.



10. Self-Check

Question 1

Summarise the 13 steps in three phases.

Answer: Preparation (TOE, documents, requirement template, workshop) → Evaluation (code review, vulnerability, penetration, functional) → Result (finding, impact analysis, delta, residual risk, change management).

Question 2

The evaluator's two assumptions? What follows from them?

Answer: (1) white-box — full source/document access; (2) the platform is untrusted. Consequence: a protection existing is not enough, **how easily it is bypassed** is measured.

Question 3

Why do we order the methods cheap to expensive?

Answer: Cheap/broad methods (SAST) clear easy findings; the expensive/deep method (pentest) can then focus on real, combined problems. Time and cost efficiency.

Question 4

What do ISO 27001 and Common Criteria certify separately?

Answer: ISO 27001 certifies the **organisation** (process), Common Criteria the **product**. One does not require the other.

Question 5

The five factors of attack potential? Why is a low score serious?

Answer: time, expertise, knowledge of the target, window of opportunity, equipment. A low total = an easy attack = a **serious finding**.

Question 6

What do attack potential and CVSS each measure? Why together?

Answer: Attack potential measures **likelihood** (difficulty), CVSS measures **impact** (loss of C/I/A). Both are given together for prioritisation.

Question 7

The finding–recommendation–action cycle. How can a finding close as "not open"?

Answer: The laboratory produces a recommendation, the developer produces an action. Some findings close, with justification, as a **good-practice suggestion**, not a security vulnerability.

Question 8

The difference between impact analysis and delta assessment? Whose job is each?

Answer: Impact analysis **documents** the change's impact (developer); delta **re-evaluates** only the change (laboratory).

Question 9

The four headings of a penetration test plan?

Answer: scope, rules of engagement, methodology, test template. Each makes the result legitimate, repeatable, and safe.

Question 10

Why does a "kill switch" exist in the rules of engagement?

Answer: If a critical/unforeseen impact is observed, the test stops immediately and is reported; it limits harm and legal risk.

Question 11

Which field of the test card links to S17?

Answer: the "related requirement" field — every test is tied to a requirement/asset, tracked with the compliance matrix (S17).

Question 12

What does it mean that at the final S16 needs "results," not a "plan"?

Answer: Writing a test plan is not enough; you must **run the tests and present the observed results** and finding–action.

Glossary (1)

Term	Meaning
TOE	The exact object evaluated (unique)
SAST/DAST	Static / dynamic testing
Fuzzing	Finding crashes with random input
Penetration test	Permitted, planned attacker-view testing
Attack potential	Difficulty of breaking it

Glossary (2)

Term	Meaning
CVSS	Vulnerability impact score
Finding-action	Laboratory recommendation → developer response
Impact analysis	Security impact of a change (developer)
Delta assessment	Re-evaluating only the change (laboratory)
Rules of engagement	The permission/scope/limit contract of a test

Summary: This Week in One Sentence

Security is not a claim, it is a quality **independently tested and measured**; a protection existing is not enough, **how much it withstands** is measured in a planned, permitted, and repeatable way.

A good test plan carries trust from **claim to evidence**.



11. References and Further Reading

References

- **Secure programming technical guide** — the delivered document, impact/delta structure, requirement block
- **OWASP MASVS / MASTG** — mobile requirements + test guide
- **OWASP WSTG** — web test guide
- **PTES, NIST SP 800-115** — penetration-test methodology
- **Common Criteria (ISO/IEC 15408)** + attack-potential guides
- **CVSS**

Next Week

Week 13 — Security Requirements

This week we saw the "requirement template" and the "compliance matrix" inside the process; in week 13 we go into detail on how to write a good requirement, the traceability/compliance matrix, and the Common Criteria, FIPS 140-3, ETSI, EMVCo, PCI, and MASVS requirement sets.